



2026 - 27 EDITION • STUDENT & PARENT GUIDE

The Ultimate Abroad MBBS *Handbook*

Everything an Indian student and parent should know before choosing MBBS abroad — eligibility, NMC regulations, country comparisons, costs, and licensing.

PHILIPPINES

RUSSIA

UZBEKISTAN

KYRGYZSTAN

VIETNAM

TIMOR-LESTE

CENTRAL AMERICA

MathuraOverseas

Your Gateway to a Global Medical Career

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This handbook is for general educational guidance only. Tuition, living costs, regulations, and exam formats change – always verify current figures with the university and the latest NMC / NBEMS notifications before making any payment.

CHAPTER 01

Why Study MBBS Abroad?

01

"Choosing the right country and university is more important than simply choosing the lowest tuition fee."

Every year, lakhs of Indian students aspire to become doctors, but government MBBS seats are limited and private colleges in India can be expensive. Studying MBBS abroad has become a practical option for eligible students — provided they choose a university that complies with the NMC's Foreign Medical Graduate Licentiate (FMGL) Regulations, 2021, and prepare consistently for the licensing examinations that follow.

• Why Students Choose MBBS Abroad

- **Affordable education** — significantly lower cost than many private Indian medical colleges.
- **International exposure** — different healthcare systems, cultures, and patient populations.
- **Modern infrastructure** — labs, simulation centres, and teaching hospitals.
- **English-medium programs** — widely available, especially in the Philippines and parts of Central America.
- **Diverse clinical experience** — hands-on exposure through affiliated teaching hospitals.

• Is MBBS Abroad Right for You?

- ☐ Have qualified NEET-UG (mandatory to practice in India after a foreign medical degree)
- ☐ Are committed to completing your medical education abroad
- ☐ Are willing to adapt to a new culture, language, and learning environment
- ☐ Are prepared to work consistently toward FMGE/NExT, as applicable
- ☐ Have carefully researched and selected an NMC-compliant university

● Myth vs. Fact

MYTH	REALITY
MBBS abroad is only for students with low NEET scores.	Many high-performing students also choose it for affordability, exposure, or career goals.
Every foreign medical degree is valid in India.	Only graduates who satisfy applicable NMC requirements and licensing regulations are eligible for registration.
The cheapest university is always the best choice.	Quality of education, clinical exposure, accreditation, and compliance matter far more than tuition alone.
English-medium means no local language is needed.	Many countries expect at least basic local-language skills for clinical/patient interaction.
You can ignore FMGE/NExT preparation until graduation.	Early, consistent preparation throughout the course significantly improves readiness.

CHAPTER 02

NEET & the NMC FMGL Regulations, 2021

Read this chapter carefully — admission without understanding these rules can affect your eligibility to practice in India.

• The FMGL Regulations, 2021 — at a Glance

Notified by the National Medical Commission (NMC) on 18 November 2021, the FMGL Regulations set the conditions Indian students studying medicine abroad must satisfy to seek registration to practice in India. They remain the governing framework in 2026.

54 months

MINIMUM COURSE
DURATION

12 months

MANDATORY
INTERNSHIP, SAME
INSTITUTION

100%

ENGLISH-MEDIUM
INSTRUCTION

+12 months

INTERNSHIP IN INDIA,
POST-LICENSING

• Why These Rules Exist

- **Patient safety first** — clinical training must be substantial enough to produce a competent, practice-ready doctor.
- **Parity with Indian MBBS** — the course must be broadly equivalent in duration, theory, and hands-on exposure.
- **Closing loopholes** — the rules exist specifically to stop degree-mill shortcuts and split/fake internships.

• Step 1 — NEET-UG Is Mandatory

If you plan to practice medicine in India after an MBBS abroad, qualifying NEET-UG is mandatory — a foreign degree alone does not make you eligible for registration in India.

- Qualified in NEET-UG
- Completed 10+2 with Physics, Chemistry, Biology/Biotechnology and English
- Met the minimum qualifying marks prescribed under applicable regulations
- Completed 17 years of age on or before 31 December of the year of admission

• The 10 Rules Every Student Must Know

- 1 **Minimum course duration** of 54 months (4.5 years), excluding internship.
- 2 **Mandatory 12-month internship** at the same foreign institution/country — split internships are not accepted.
- 3 **English medium** throughout; any online component must be compensated with equivalent offline training.
- 4 **Curriculum broadly equivalent** to the Indian MBBS curriculum, in theory, practical and clinical training.
- 5 **Local licensure eligibility** — you should be eligible to seek registration in the country where you studied.
- 6 **Adequate clinical training** and hands-on hospital exposure.
- 7 **A recognised medical institution**, legally recognised in its own country.
- 8 **A further 12-month internship in India** is generally required before permanent registration.
- 9 **A licensing examination** — currently FMGE, until NExT is implemented for foreign graduates (Chapter 06).
- 10 **Don't rely on marketing claims** — never choose a university based only on low fees or "100% pass" advertising.

i Did you know? India's number of medical aspirants each year far exceeds available government MBBS seats — one reason many eligible students explore recognised international universities while ensuring compliance with Indian regulations.

! Red flags before admission: the university can't clearly explain its internship structure; the curriculum isn't fully in English where advertised; it can't demonstrate FMGL compliance; or it makes unrealistic promises about licensing.

✓ Regulatory note (verified 2026): The FMGL Regulations, 2021 remain in force with no material amendment to these ten conditions. FMGE continues as the licensing exam for foreign graduates through 2026; NExT has no confirmed implementation date for this group. Always check nmc.org.in for the latest notifications before admission.

CHAPTER 03 • DESTINATION

Philippines

03

American curriculum • English medium • excellent clinical exposure • affordable education

BS-MD pathway

Tropical climate

₹18-35 L total

For more than two decades, the Philippines has been a preferred destination for Indian medical students. It follows an American-style medical education system, English is the primary medium of instruction, and students get extensive patient interaction through affiliated teaching hospitals.

• Course Structure

PHASE	DURATION	CONTENT
BS (Pre-Medicine)	~1.5-2 years	Biology, Chemistry, Psychology, Mathematics, Communication
Doctor of Medicine (MD)	4 years	Pre-clinical & clinical sciences, hospital rotations, clerkship
Internship	1 year	Clinical internship per university and local regulations

Confirm your complete course structure satisfies the FMGL Regulations (Chapter 02) before enrolling.

• Approximate Tuition (Complete Program)

UNIVERSITY	APPROX. TUITION
Lyceum Northwestern University	₹18-24 Lakhs
University of Northern Philippines	₹18-24 Lakhs
UV Gullas College of Medicine	₹18-25 Lakhs
Davao Medical School Foundation	₹20-28 Lakhs
Emilio Aguinaldo College	₹22-30 Lakhs
AMA School of Medicine	₹22-30 Lakhs
Our Lady of Fatima University	₹24-32 Lakhs
University of Perpetual Help	₹24-32 Lakhs
Cebu Doctors' University	₹24-35 Lakhs

Excludes accommodation, food, visa, travel, and insurance. Average monthly living budget: ₹20,000-35,000.

20+ yrs

HOSTING INDIAN
MEDICAL STUDENTS

BS + MD

AMERICAN-PATTERN
PATHWAY

English

FULL MEDIUM OF
INSTRUCTION

Tropical

CLIMATE, YEAR-
ROUND

• Advantages & Points to Consider

ADVANTAGES

- English-medium, American-pattern curriculum
- Strong, early clinical exposure
- Large Indian student community

CONSIDER

- The BS–MD pathway differs structurally from India's MBBS
- Local licensure depends on Philippine law and any reciprocity provisions
- Confirm NMC FMGL compliance before paying any fee



Good to know: local licensure in the Philippines runs through the Physician Licensure Examination (PLE) — separate from India's FMGE/NExT. Most Indian students following the FMGL pathway back to India do not need to sit the PLE unless they intend to practise in the Philippines itself.

CHAPTER 04 • DESTINATIONS

Russia, Uzbekistan, Kyrgyzstan, Vietnam & Timor-Leste

Five more popular destinations — choose a university on quality and NMC compliance, not just low tuition.

Russia

6-year MD

Cold climate

₹15k–25k/mo. living

Russia has hosted Indian medical students for more than 60 years. Its government universities offer experienced faculty, modern labs, and large teaching hospitals, with English-medium options at many institutions.

UNIVERSITY	APPROX. TUITION
Bashkir State Medical University	₹18–28 Lakhs
Orenburg State Medical University	₹18–26 Lakhs
Crimea Federal University	₹18–28 Lakhs
Volgograd State Medical University	₹20–30 Lakhs
Perm State Medical University	₹20–30 Lakhs
Kazan State Medical University	₹22–32 Lakhs
First Moscow State Medical University	₹40–60 Lakhs
RUDN University	₹40–65 Lakhs

Consider: cold climate in many regions; basic Russian is useful for clinical interaction.

Uzbekistan

6-year MD

Moderate climate

₹12k–20k/mo. living

Uzbekistan has grown popular for its affordability and modern campuses, with a rising number of English-medium programs — but the NMC has specifically advised extra caution when verifying admissions here.

UNIVERSITY	APPROX. TUITION
Andijan State Medical Institute	₹16–22 Lakhs
Fergana Medical Institute of Public Health	₹15–22 Lakhs
Bukhara State Medical Institute	₹17–24 Lakhs
Tashkent Medical Academy	₹18–24 Lakhs
Samarkand State Medical University	₹18–25 Lakhs
Tashkent Pediatric Medical Institute	₹18–25 Lakhs

! Important advisory: do not assume every university or campus in Uzbekistan automatically meets NMC requirements. Verify recognition, confirm course duration and internship structure, and ensure the curriculum aligns with FMGL before admission.

● Kyrgyzstan

One of the most affordable destinations, with English-medium programs and a growing Indian student community — verify the specific university carefully.

UNIVERSITY	APPROX. TUITION
Asian Medical Institute	₹18–22 Lakhs
Jalal-Abad State University	₹20–23 Lakhs
Osh State University	₹22–25 Lakhs
Kyrgyz State Medical Academy	₹24–28 Lakhs
International University of Kyrgyzstan	₹26–30 Lakhs
International School of Medicine (ISM)	₹28–33 Lakhs

Living cost: ₹12,000–20,000/month. Consider: cold winters; basic local language helps during clinical postings.

● Vietnam

An emerging destination with modern infrastructure and safe cities. English-medium availability varies by institution — some require Vietnamese for clinical communication.

UNIVERSITY	APPROX. TUITION
Can Tho University of Medicine and Pharmacy	₹28–38 Lakhs
Hue University of Medicine and Pharmacy	₹30–40 Lakhs
Hanoi Medical University	₹35–45 Lakhs
University of Medicine and Pharmacy, HCMC	₹35–45 Lakhs

Living cost: ₹18,000–30,000/month.

● Timor-Leste

A relatively new, emerging option with affordable fees and English-supported instruction at selected institutions. Fewer Indian students are currently enrolled — extra due diligence is essential.

INSTITUTION	APPROX. TUITION
Universidade Cristal Timor (UCT), Dili	₹15–20 Lakhs

Living cost: ₹15,000–25,000/month.

- ✓ **Expert tip:** never finalise a university based only on social media advertisements or a fee chart. Ask for the complete curriculum, internship details, hospital affiliations, and NMC compliance before paying any admission fee.

CHAPTER 05 • DESTINATION

Central America & the Caribbean

05

English-medium education with USMLE-oriented pathways — for students planning a global medical career.

Central America and the Caribbean appeal to students seeking English-medium instruction, modern campuses, and (at some institutions) USMLE-focused curricula supporting careers in North America. Tuition and living costs here are generally the highest among the destinations in this handbook.

! **Important:** not every institution here meets India's registration requirements. Students planning to return to India must verify FMGL compliance before admission.

COUNTRY	SAMPLE UNIVERSITIES	APPROX. TUITION
Guyana	Texila American, Lincoln American, Green Heart Medical	₹35–50 L
Belize	CAHSU, Columbus Central University	₹35–55 L
Antigua & Barbuda	American University of Antigua, Metropolitan University	₹40–90 L
Dominica	All Saints University, American Canadian School of Medicine	₹38–50 L
Grenada	St. George's University	₹1.2–1.8 Cr

Living cost: ₹35,000–60,000/month. St. George's University is internationally known for extensive clinical partnerships but is also among the most expensive options in this handbook.

ADVANTAGES

- English-speaking environment
- USMLE-focused curriculum at many institutions
- International faculty, modern simulation labs

CONSIDER

- Higher tuition and living costs than Asian destinations
- Confirm clinical training sites and internship arrangements
- Verify FMGL compliance before admission

CHAPTER 06

Compare Before You Choose — & Your Career After

There is no single "best" country — and your degree is only the beginning. Compare destinations, then plan for FMGE/NExT.

FEATURE	PH	RU	UZ	KG	VN	TL	CA
Duration	BS+MD	6 yrs	6 yrs	6 yrs	6 yrs	6 yrs	5–6 yrs
Instruction	English	Eng/Rus	English	English	Eng+local	English*	English
Tuition	₹18–35L	₹18–60L	₹15–25L	₹18–33L	₹28–45L	₹15–20L	₹35L–1.8Cr
Living/mo	₹20–35k	₹15–25k	₹12–20k	₹12–20k	₹18–30k	₹15–25k	₹35–60k
Climate	Tropical	Cold	Moderate	Cold	Tropical	Tropical	Tropical
Clinical exp.	Excellent	Excellent	Good	Good	Good	Developing	Good*

*selected institutions / varies by university

• Decision Matrix

IF YOU WANT...	CONSIDER...
Lowest budget	Kyrgyzstan / Uzbekistan
English-medium, American-style learning	Philippines
Well-established government universities	Russia
An emerging Asian option	Vietnam
North America-oriented pathways	Selected Central American institutions

• Ask These 10 Questions Before Choosing Any University

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Is the university recognised in its home country? | ☐ What are the total costs beyond tuition? |
| ☐ Does the program align with the FMGL Regulations? | ☐ Is there a strong Indian student support system? |
| ☐ Is the entire course taught in English where advertised? | ☐ What hostel and safety facilities are available? |
| ☐ How much clinical exposure will I receive, and where? | ☐ Does the university provide transparent documentation? |
| ☐ Where will I complete my internship? | ☐ Have I independently verified the latest information myself? |

• FMGE, NExT & Your Career After MBBS Abroad

"Your university can provide opportunities, but your success depends on your knowledge, discipline, and consistent preparation."

• What Is FMGE?

The Foreign Medical Graduate Examination (FMGE) is a screening exam conducted by the National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences (NBEMS) for Indian citizens and OCI cardholders who obtain a primary medical qualification outside India and wish to register to practice in India.

300

MCQS, TWO PARTS

150/300

PASSING MARKS (50%)

0

NEGATIVE MARKING

2×/yrJUNE & DECEMBER
SESSIONS

FMGE pass rates (recent sessions): official NBEMS data shows FMGE is consistently challenging. Recent overall session pass rates have generally fallen in the roughly 20–30% range — for example, the January 2026 session recorded about 24% (10,264 of 42,872 candidates). Pass rates are not published reliably by university or country; treat any consultancy's claimed "university pass rate" figures with caution unless officially sourced.

• FMGE vs. NExT — 2026 Status

The National Exit Test (NExT) is designed to eventually replace both FMGE and NEET-PG as a single licensing exam. As of this edition, **FMGE remains the only active licensing pathway for foreign medical graduates**, and NExT has no confirmed implementation date for this group — students admitted in 2026 may not face it until around 2031–32 at the earliest, if the transition proceeds as currently discussed. Prepare for FMGE — don't defer preparation in anticipation of NExT.

• How to Increase Your Chances

- Start revising from first year — don't wait for final year
- Solve MCQs weekly using standard question banks
- Focus during clinical rotations — real patient exposure, history-taking, examination skills
- Use standard medical textbooks alongside university notes
- Consider a structured FMGE coaching program during the clinical years

• FMGE-Specific Myths

MYTH	REALITY
"The Philippines has 100% FMGE pass."	No official data supports university-wise claims like this.
"Russia is too difficult."	Success depends far more on individual preparation than country.
"Final-year coaching is sufficient."	Continuous preparation from year one is consistently more effective.

"A medical degree is not the final destination. It is the beginning of your journey."

CHAPTER 07

Admission Process, Visa & Documents

A well-planned admission process saves time, avoids unnecessary expense, and gets you into your preferred university.

• The 10-Step Journey

- 1 **Qualify NEET-UG** — keep your scorecard, admit card, and All India Rank ready.
- 2 **Choose the right country & university** — compare compliance, recognition, exposure, budget, and safety.
- 3 **Free career counselling** — clarify budget fit, career goals, and total expenses.
- 4 **Document verification** — marksheets, NEET scorecard, passport, photographs, birth certificate.
- 5 **University application** — leads to a Provisional Admission/Offer Letter after review.
- 6 **Admission confirmation** — verify the Admission Letter, Invitation Letter, and Fee Invoice before paying.
- 7 **Fee payment** — only via the official university account or an authorised partner — never a personal account.
- 8 **Student visa process** — requirements vary by country; apply early.
- 9 **Flight booking & pre-departure** — tickets, forex, insurance, original + offline copies of documents.
- 10 **Arrival** — pickup, hostel allotment, registration, medical check-up, ID card, orientation, classes begin.

• Documents Checklist

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Passport | ☐ Medical fitness certificate |
| ☐ 10th & 12th marksheets | ☐ Police clearance certificate (country-specific) |
| ☐ NEET scorecard | ☐ Admission letter |
| ☐ Passport-size photographs | ☐ Student visa |
| ☐ Birth certificate (if required) | ☐ Air ticket & travel insurance (if applicable) |

● Ideal Admission Timeline

PERIOD	ACTIVITY
April–May	NEET-UG examination
May–June	Research countries & universities
June–July	Apply to universities
July	Receive admission letter
July–August	Student visa process
August–September	Travel & university registration
September–October	Classes begin

The exact timeline varies by country and intake — earlier applications generally mean more choices and smoother visa processing.

10 Steps

FROM NEET TO
ARRIVAL

4–6 wks

TYPICAL VISA
PROCESSING TIME

Apr–May

NEET-UG
EXAMINATION
WINDOW

Sep–Oct

MOST INTAKES BEGIN
CLASSES

i Plan around intake cycles. Most universities in this handbook run a single major intake per year (a few offer a smaller secondary intake). Missing the primary window can mean waiting almost a full year for the next one — so treat the June–July application step as the real deadline, not the visa step.

CHAPTER 08

Student Life Abroad

08

Studying abroad is not just about earning a degree — it's about adapting to a new culture and building independence.

ACCOMMODATION

Most universities provide on-campus or affiliated hostels — furnished, with Wi-Fi, laundry, 24×7 security, and common kitchen/recreation areas. Private apartments may become an option after year one.

FOOD

Most popular destinations have Indian restaurants, grocery stores, or hostel-mess options, especially in cities with a large Indian student community.

SIM & BANKING

A local SIM is usually easy to obtain after arrival. Open a local bank account if required, use an international debit/forex card, and track spending with a budgeting app.

WEATHER & PACKING

Philippines, Vietnam, Timor-Leste, and Central America are tropical; Russia and Kyrgyzstan are cold; Uzbekistan is moderate. Pack for your destination and season.

• Average Monthly Living Expenses

COUNTRY	APPROX. MONTHLY COST
Uzbekistan / Kyrgyzstan	₹12,000–20,000
Russia	₹15,000–25,000
Timor-Leste	₹15,000–25,000
Vietnam	₹18,000–30,000
Philippines	₹20,000–35,000
Central America	₹35,000–60,000

HABITS OF SUCCESSFUL STUDENTS

- Maintain excellent attendance
- Eat balanced meals, stay hydrated, exercise, sleep enough
- Learn basic local-language phrases
- Stay connected with family for support

SAFETY TIPS

- Keep photocopies and digital copies of every document
- Save emergency contact numbers
- Avoid carrying large amounts of cash
- Inform family before travelling to another city

CHAPTER 09

Costly Mistakes to Avoid

09

"The biggest regret isn't studying abroad. It's choosing the wrong university without proper research."

MISTAKE	WHY IT HURTS
Choosing a university only because it's cheap	A ₹2–3 lakh saving today can cost far more if academics or clinical exposure are weak.
Ignoring the FMGL Regulations	Course duration, internship structure, and medium of instruction all affect eligibility to register in India.
Believing every advertisement	"100% FMGE pass" and "guaranteed registration" claims aren't backed by official data.
Choosing a country instead of a university	Quality varies widely even within the same country.
Not asking about hidden costs	Hostel, visa, insurance, lab and exam fees, documentation, and flights all add up.
Waiting until the last minute	Late applications mean fewer choices, visa delays, and higher airfare.
Ignoring clinical exposure	Ask about teaching hospitals, patient flow, and internship quality.
Forgetting FMGE/NExT preparation	Waiting until graduation to start puts you at a real disadvantage.

• The Complete Pre-Admission Checklist

Before paying any admission fee, you should be able to answer "yes" to every item below.

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ I have qualified NEET-UG | ☐ I understand the licensing requirements for my graduation year |
| ☐ I understand the complete course structure | ☐ I have compared multiple universities, not just one |
| ☐ I know the total cost — not just tuition | ☐ I have spoken with current students or alumni where possible |
| ☐ I have independently verified the university's recognition | ☐ I have read the admission letter and fee invoice carefully |
| ☐ I have checked the internship details and location requirements | ☐ My decision is based on verified facts — not advertisements |



Expert tip: a quality medical education is an investment in your future. Saving a few lakhs today by choosing the wrong university can cost far more in time, career opportunities, and licensing challenges later.

● You're Likely on the Right Track If...

- The university freely shares its FMGL compliance documents, without being asked twice
- Current students or alumni are reachable and speak positively about clinical exposure
- The fee structure is written down in full, with no pressure to "pay today to lock the seat"
- Your counsellor is comparing universities with you — not steering you to just one

"A medical degree may earn you the title of Doctor, but your knowledge, ethics, and compassion will earn you the trust of your patients."

CHAPTER 10

Why Choose Mathura Overseas?

10

"We don't just help you secure admission — we help you build your medical career."

Mathura Overseas helps Indian students pursue quality medical education abroad through honest guidance, transparent counselling, and end-to-end support — recommending universities based on career goals and compliance, not marketing claims.

BEFORE ADMISSION

- Expert career counselling matched to your budget and goals
- University selection based on academics, clinical exposure, faculty, and compliance
- Application processing, documentation, and fee guidance

VISA & BEYOND

- Student visa guidance, forex assistance, and flight booking support
- Airport pickup coordination and hostel assistance
- Ongoing student and parent support after arrival

• Our Commitment

Transparency, honest counselling, verified information, and student-centric guidance — we never recommend a university solely because it is the cheapest.

This handbook is prepared for general educational guidance. Verify current NMC/NBEMS notifications and university fee structures before making any decision.

About This Handbook

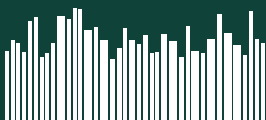
This handbook distils everything an Indian family needs before committing to an MBBS abroad — from NEET eligibility and the NMC's FMGL Regulations, 2021, through country-by-country comparisons, real tuition ranges, admission steps, and what FMGE/NEt actually demands after graduation. Written to be read once, then kept as a reference through the entire admission journey.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- NEET eligibility & NMC FMGL Regulations, 2021
- Philippines, Russia, Uzbekistan & more, compared
- Real approximate tuition & living-cost ranges
- FMGE / NEt exam pattern & pass-rate data
- Step-by-step admission, visa & document checklist
- Student life abroad & the mistakes to avoid

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